The Bureau of Meteorology

IDS11072
Australian Government Bureau of Meteorology
South Australia

Coastal Waters Forecast for South Australia

Issued at 3:40 am CDT on Tuesday 20 October 2026
for the period until midnight CDT Thursday 22 October 2026.

Please be aware
Wind and wave forecasts are averages. Wind gusts can be 40 per cent stronger than the forecast, and stronger still in squalls and thunderstorms. Maximum waves can be twice the forecast height.

Warning Information

For latest warnings go to www.bom.gov.au, subscribe to RSS feeds, call 1300 659 210* or listen for warnings on relevant TV and radio broadcasts.

Weather Situation

A trough of low pressure over southeastern South Australia lingers in the east, before weakening from Thursday. A slow moving high pressure system in the Tasman Sea re-establishes a ridge across southern parts from Wednesday. Another series of troughs move into western parts on Thursday and broadly across SA on Friday.

Far West Coast: WA-SA Border to Fowlers Bay

Forecast for Tuesday 20 October until midnight

Winds: Variable about 10 knots becoming east to southeasterly 10 to 15 knots in the early afternoon. Winds reaching up to 20 knots offshore in the late evening. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 metres inshore, increasing to 1.5 to 2 metres offshore. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Wednesday 21 October

Winds: East to southeasterly 10 to 15 knots, reaching up to 20 knots offshore during the morning. Winds tending east to northeasterly before dawn then tending east to southeasterly in the early afternoon. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres, decreasing below 1 metre around midday. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 to 2 metres, increasing to 2 to 3 metres during the morning. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Thursday 22 October

Winds: East to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots tending north to northeasterly during the morning then shifting south to southeasterly during the afternoon. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Upper West Coast: Fowlers Bay to Elliston

Forecast for Tuesday 20 October until midnight

Winds: Southerly 10 to 15 knots tending southeasterly in the late evening. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Wednesday 21 October

Winds: Southeasterly 10 to 15 knots tending easterly in the early morning then turning south to southeasterly in the late morning. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 1.5 to 2 metres, increasing to 2 to 3 metres during the morning. Weather: Sunny.

Forecast for Thursday 22 October

Winds: Variable about 10 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2.5 to 3 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

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Lower West Coast: Elliston to Cape Carnot

Forecast for Tuesday 20 October until midnight

Winds: Southerly 10 to 15 knots tending southeasterly in the late evening. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Wednesday 21 October

Winds: East to southeasterly about 10 knots tending south to southeasterly 10 to 15 knots in the early afternoon then tending east to southeasterly in the late evening. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2 metres, increasing to 2 to 3 metres during the morning. Weather: Sunny.

Forecast for Thursday 22 October

Winds: Easterly 10 to 15 knots turning north to northeasterly below 10 knots during the morning then becoming variable during the day. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 3 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Central Coast

Forecast for Tuesday 20 October until midnight

Winds: South to southwesterly 10 to 15 knots, reaching up to 20 knots inshore early in the morning. Winds turning southeasterly in the late evening. Seas: Around 1 metre, decreasing below 0.5 metres during the morning, then increasing to below 1 metre around midday. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy. The chance of a thunderstorm inshore late this afternoon and evening.

Forecast for Wednesday 21 October

Winds: Southeasterly about 10 knots becoming east to northeasterly in the morning then tending east to southeasterly 10 to 15 knots in the early afternoon. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2 metres, increasing to 2 to 3 metres during the morning. Weather: Sunny.

Forecast for Thursday 22 October

Winds: East to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots becoming variable about 10 knots during the morning. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 3 metres. Weather: Mostly sunny.

South Central Coast

Forecast for Tuesday 20 October until midnight

Winds: Southwesterly 15 to 20 knots turning south to southeasterly below 10 knots during the day. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Cloudy. The chance of a thunderstorm during the morning and afternoon.

Forecast for Wednesday 21 October

Winds: Variable about 10 knots becoming east to southeasterly 10 to 15 knots in the late afternoon. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2 metres, increasing to 2 to 3 metres during the morning. Weather: Cloud clearing.

Forecast for Thursday 22 October

Winds: Easterly 10 to 15 knots turning north to northeasterly below 10 knots during the morning then becoming variable during the day. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 3 metres, increasing to 3 to 4 metres west of Kangaroo Island. Weather: Mostly sunny.

Upper South East Coast: Murray Mouth to Cape Jaffa

Forecast for Tuesday 20 October until midnight

Winds: North to northwesterly 10 to 15 knots shifting southerly in the early afternoon. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2 metres. Weather: Cloudy. The chance of a thunderstorm.

Forecast for Wednesday 21 October

Winds: South to southeasterly about 10 knots increasing to 10 to 15 knots in the early afternoon. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2 metres, increasing to 2 to 3 metres around midday. Weather: Cloud clearing.

Forecast for Thursday 22 October

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Winds: Variable below 10 knots becoming north to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots during the morning then becoming variable about 10 knots during the day. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2.5 to 3 metres. Weather: Mostly sunny.

Lower South East Coast: Cape Jaffa to SA-VIC Border

Forecast for Tuesday 20 October until midnight

Winds: North to northwesterly 10 to 15 knots shifting south to southwesterly early in the morning then decreasing to about 10 knots in the evening. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 2.5 metres. Weather: Cloudy. The chance of a thunderstorm during the morning and afternoon.

Forecast for Wednesday 21 October

Winds: Variable about 10 knots becoming southeasterly 10 to 15 knots in the early afternoon. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 2 to 3 metres, increasing to 3 to 4 metres south of Port MacDonnell during the afternoon. Weather: Cloud clearing.

Forecast for Thursday 22 October

Winds: East to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots turning north to northwesterly during the morning then becoming variable below 10 knots during the afternoon. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 3 metres inshore, increasing to 3 to 4 metres offshore. Weather: Mostly sunny.

Spencer Gulf

Forecast for Tuesday 20 October until midnight

Winds: Southwesterly 15 to 20 knots turning southerly during the morning and early afternoon. Seas: 1 to 1.5 metres, decreasing to 1 metre during the morning, then increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres by early evening. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre, increasing to around 1 metre south of Cowell to Wallaroo. Weather: Partly cloudy. The chance of a thunderstorm, with possible squalls north of Cowell to Wallaroo during this afternoon and evening.

Forecast for Wednesday 21 October

Winds: South to southeasterly 10 to 15 knots tending south to southwesterly in the middle of the day then tending south to southeasterly in the evening. Winds reaching up to 20 knots north of Cowell to Wallaroo in the late afternoon. Seas: Around 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres south of Cowell to Wallaroo during the afternoon. Weather: Cloud clearing.

Forecast for Thursday 22 October

Winds: Variable about 10 knots becoming east to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots during the morning then becoming variable about 10 knots during the evening. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres south of Cowell to Wallaroo. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Gulf St Vincent

Forecast for Tuesday 20 October until midnight

Winds: West to southwesterly 10 to 15 knots turning southerly in the late morning. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly below 0.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy. The chance of a thunderstorm.

Forecast for Wednesday 21 October

Winds: South to southeasterly 10 to 15 knots tending south to southwesterly in the middle of the day then tending south to southeasterly in the evening. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly below 0.5 metres. Weather: Cloud clearing.

Forecast for Thursday 22 October

Winds: Variable about 10 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Investigator Strait

Forecast for Tuesday 20 October until midnight

Winds: Southwesterly 10 to 15 knots, reaching up to 20 knots inshore early in the morning. Winds turning south to southeasterly in the evening. Seas: Around 1 metre, decreasing below 0.5 metres during the morning, then increasing to below 1 metre around midday. Swell: West to southwesterly 1 to 1.5 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy. The chance of a thunderstorm during the morning and afternoon.

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Forecast for Wednesday 21 October

Winds: Southeasterly 10 to 15 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres during the afternoon. Weather: Mostly sunny.

Forecast for Thursday 22 October

Winds: Variable about 10 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly 1 to 1.5 metres, increasing to 1 to 2 metres inshore. Weather: Mostly sunny.

The next routine forecast will be issued at 9:30 am CDT Tuesday.

* Calls to 1300 numbers cost around 27.5c incl. GST, higher from mobiles or public phones. Marine forecasts are also available on VHF and HF radio. View the radio schedule on www.bom.gov.au/marine

Check the latest Coastal Waters Forecasts for information on wind, wave and weather conditions for neighbouring coastal zones.

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